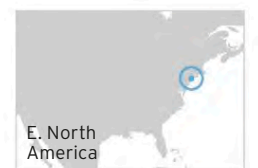




TWA Flight Center, JFK Airport

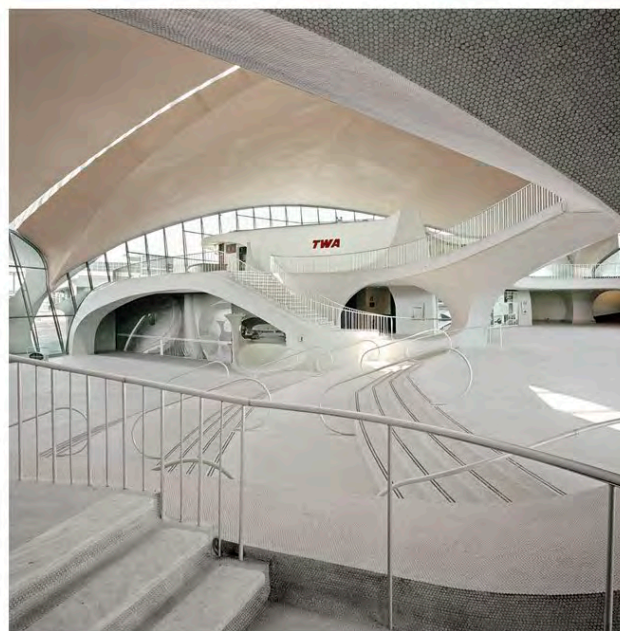
A space-age flight terminal, described as the “Grand Central” of the jet age



In 1955, the authorities at New York’s Idlewild Airport—renamed John F. Kennedy Airport in December 1963 in honor of the late president—determined that each of the major airlines using the airport should build and operate their own terminal. Trans World Airlines (TWA) selected a bold, futuristic building by the Finnish American architect Eero Saarinen. Saarinen’s terminal was a monument to aviation itself. It was covered with a prominent wing-shaped, white concrete roof, while tall windows allowed passengers to view the incoming and outgoing aircraft outside.

Passenger innovations

The new terminal opened on May 28, 1962, a year after Saarinen’s premature death. It was one of the first to feature enclosed passenger jetways to allow passengers to enter and leave their aircraft safe from the elements outside. The terminal also sported baggage carousels, an electronic schedule board, and closed-circuit television (CCTV), all innovations at that time. In 1969, the terminal was expanded to handle more passengers. It closed in 2001, but was granted a new lease of life in 2015, when plans were announced to convert it into a hotel.



◁ FLUID INTERIORS

The inside of the terminal is remarkably coordinated and harmonious. It is free of obtruding pillars or walls, which gives an impression of openness inside.